



Gray Eagle Extended Range (GE-ER)

Reach, Persistence, Lethality

Gray Eagle Extended Range (GE-ER) is a next-generation advanced derivative of the battle-proven Gray Eagle Unmanned Aircraft System (UAS). GE-ER delivers long-endurance UAS surveillance, communications relay, and weapons delivery missions in support of the warfighter. The aircraft delivers an advanced UAS capability for the Army, adding significantly increased endurance, considerably improved reliability/maintainability, and much greater payload and weapons capacity. First flown in July 2013, GE-ER builds upon the successes of its Gray Eagle predecessor, delivering upgraded, game-changing capabilities for saving the lives of Army soldiers abroad by providing extended surveillance coverage, along with the ability to self-transit to distant locations.

GE-ER is engineered with a Max Gross Takeoff Weight (MGTOG) of 4,200 pounds, utilizing a high-performance 180HP diesel engine compared with the Gray Eagle's GTOW of 3,600 pounds with a 160HP diesel engine. The incorporation of GE-ER's deep belly design and 500-pound centerline hard point allows for 900 pounds of internal fuel load, with the capability of an external fuel pod that can accommodate an additional 450 pounds (Gray Eagle's fuel load is 600 pounds). Use of this extra fuel supports persistent Army Reconnaissance, Surveillance, and Target Acquisition (RSTA) missions. GE-ER endurance has been demonstrated in all Army operational configurations and flew nearly two days straight during testing at GA-ASI's Flight Operations Facility in El Mirage, California.

GE-ER's internal payload capacity, combined with its increased engine horsepower, provides growth capability for an improved airworthiness design, with the potential of incorporating lightning protection, damage tolerance, and Traffic Collision Avoidance System (TCAS) features.

GE-ER features an automatic takeoff and landing system (ATLS) that allows the aircraft to be launched and recovered without any operator interaction. Its ATLS is based upon GA-ASI's Gray Eagle ATLS which has successfully conducted tens of thousands of takeoffs and landings.

Features and Benefits:

- Technologically advanced derivative of the combat-proven Gray Eagle UAS
- Increased endurance
- Dedicated to direct operational control by U.S. Army field commanders
- Unprecedented reliability
- Triple-redundant avionics and flight controls
- Redundant flight control surfaces
- Common Data Link (CDL) line-of-sight communications/air data relay communications
- Satellite communications
- Open systems architecture supports integration of multiple payloads simultaneously, with capacity for growth
- Automatic takeoff and landing reduces pilot workload

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Objective

Provide a long-endurance, aerial Reconnaissance, Surveillance, Target Acquisition (RSTA) capability for combat aviation brigades at division level and aerial exploitation battalions for echelons above division.

Characteristics	
Wingspan:	58 ft (17m)
Length:	28 ft (9m)
Power Plant:	180-hp Heavy Fuel Engine (HFE)
Max Gross Takeoff Weight:	4,200 lb (1,905 kg)
Fuel Capacity:	900 lb (408 kg)
Payload Capacity:	400 lb (181 kg),, internal 500 lb centerline (227 kg)
Weapons:	4 Hellfire missiles
Payloads:	EO/IR SAR/GMTI Communications relay
Power:	28 Vdc/9 kW (redundant 4.5 kW alternators)
Performance	
Max Altitude:	29,000 ft (8,839.2m)
Max Endurance:	42 hr
Max Airspeed:	167 KTAS

Gallery



MULTI-MISSION
REMOTELY PILOTED AIRCRAFT

GAMBIT SERIES

MQ-9B SKYGUARDIAN

MQ-9B SEAGUARDIAN

MQ-9B STOL

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SMALL UAS & LAUNCHED EFFECTS
MQ-9A "REAPER"
AVENGER
GRAY EAGLE 25M
GRAY EAGLE EXTENDED RANGE
GRAY EAGLE
PREDATOR XP

Features



The College With Its Own Predator® Uncrewed Aircraft

For General Atomics Aeronautical Systems, Inc. (GA-ASI), the world leader in uncrewed aircraft, that goal has seen substantial progress over a decade-long partnership with Kansas State University Salina Aerospace and Technology Campus.

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TIME TO GET REAL

The time to begin building uncrewed fighters in large numbers is now, says General Atomics Aeronautical Systems President David Alexander.

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